Anthropic Startup Partnerships

Ongun Ozdemir Application

Date: 24 Mar 2026
Dashboard GitHub Link: https://github.com/OOngun/anthropic-application
HTML GitHub Link: https://oongun.github.io/anthropic-application/

Foreword

All data in this dashboard and model are synthetic. As such, in-depth analyses and insights are manufactured for illustrative purposes only to show the effectiveness of the framework. Furthermore, more forward looking and company specific metrics are typically used which this document does not dive in to.

We have adapted early and growth stage venture capital firms' analyses to evaluate product-market fit within a partnership portfolio. These frameworks take different approaches and place different importance on metrics depending on the partner's use case and stage, as we highlight in the accompanying case studies. I believe that with proprietary Anthropic usage data, this can be further extended well beyond this dashboard.

Executive Summary

In this document, I outline an initial approach, analysis framework and, via two case studies, explore the framework against two partner archetypes. The goal here is to demonstrate how growth accounting surfaces what headline metrics hide.

The first, WriteFlow, appears healthy at a glance MAU is growing and revenue is up. Run through the framework, a different picture emerges: a Quick Ratio below the consumer threshold, high churn masking stagnant net retention, and cohort LTV that depends entirely on a small pool of surviving users. The recommendation is to monitor, not prioritise.

The second, BrieflyAI, a newer startup partner that carries a smaller MRR. But its growth accounting profile tells a different story: step-function revenue growth, NDR above 110%, and a CMGR-3 nearly ten times that of WriteFlow. By the metrics that matter, BrieflyAI is the power law candidate in the portfolio. This is the kind of partner that warrants early, deep resource allocation before the breakout becomes obvious to everyone.

The goal of the framework is to find that partner before it's obvious and bring a methodology to spot breakout successes early on, enabling the Anthropic team to allocate resources more efficiently.

Table of Contents

Foreword....1
Executive Summary....1
Table of Contents.... 2
Methodology....3
Analysis Framework....3
Navigation & Dashboard....3
Growth Accounting Approach....4
Quick Ratio....4
Gross Dollar Retention (GDR)....4
Net Dollar Retention (NDR)....4
Portfolio Revenue Share & Power Law Identification....5
Case Studies....6
Company 1: WriteFlow....6
Reccomendation....7
Case Study 2: BrieflyAI.... 8
Recommendation.... 10

Methodology

Assumptions: I've taken an initial approach which focuses on direct API usage, while ignoring enterprise agreements, Pro/Max subscriptions, and other consumption channels. By scoping to direct API partners only, the model stays clean with synthetic data and reflects the primary revenue channel that a startup's partnerships role would manage.

Analysis Framework

The key differentiation is adapting existing methods to the data points Anthropic would receive through its partners' usage. This means ignoring typical CAC:LTV ratios and other metrics we simply wouldn't have access to, focusing instead on what API consumption data does reveal: growth across revenue, users, and lifetime value through methodologies such as cohort retention analysis for churn and LTV growth analyses.

- **Growth Accounting:** Decompose revenue into new, retained, expansion, contraction, churned and resurrected to understand the true source of growth
- **Quick Ratio:** Growth efficiency; units gained per unit lost instead of burn multiple, given we don't have access to CAC.
- **Gross & Net Dollar Retention:** How much of the existing base survives (GDR) and whether it expands (NDR)
- **CMGR**: Trailing 3, 6 and 12-month compound growth acceleration or deceleration
- **Cohort LTV:** Cumulative value per user over time, revealing whether survivors deepen usage
- **Developer Retention:** Cohort-level engagement to separate sticky products from leaky ones

Navigation & Dashboard

The dashboard operates on three tiers:

Pulse: The ecosystem health check. Four headline metrics, a growth accounting waterfall with selectable time periods and scopes, a combined GA + CMGR chart, and a portfolio revenue share visualisation.

This answers "is the portfolio healthy this week?" in under ten seconds.

Partners: The navigation layer. Every partner in a sortable, colour-coded scoreboard with a Power Law Tracker ranking partners by projected scale.

This answers "who needs my attention?" and routes you to the detail view.

Company: The full drill-down. Growth accounting, cohort LTV curves and heatmaps, developer retention, model mix evolution.

This answers "why is this partner, and what should I do about it?"

Anthropic EMEA Startup Partnerships

Partner Consumption Analytics

Ongun Ozdemir · Mar 2026 · Synthetic data

$10/1M tokens blended (Sonnet/Opus/Haiku, 5:1 I/O) **65% gross margin** est. **24 months** Jan 2024 – Dec 2025

Pulse | Partners | Case Studies

PARTNERS 26 / 26

Top 3 | Top 5 | Top 10 | Active (19) | All (26)

ACTIVE PARTNERS

19

API activity in last 30d

QUICK RATIO

1.3x

(new+res+exp) / (churn+contr)

0x 1x 2x

Industry benchmarks · >4x very healthy

NET DOLLAR RETENTION

101%

Expanding · existing partners

80% 3x 4x 128 6x

Industry benchmarks (P25–P90)

GROSS RETENTION

84%

30-day rolling

0% 149 153 60 157+70

Industry benchmarks · >80% healthy

GROWTH ACCOUNTING WATERFALL

PERIOD 1M | 3M | 6M | 12M | YTD | All VIEW Bars | Table | Trend SCOPE All | Star | Strong | Fine | Declining | Churned

New	+1.4% ↓
Expansion	+9.0% ↓
Resurrected	+10.4% ↓
Contraction	-7.8% ↑
Churned	-8.6% ↑
Net Growth	+4.4% ↓

KEY ● Gains ● Losses | Period avg ○ ↑↓ vs avg

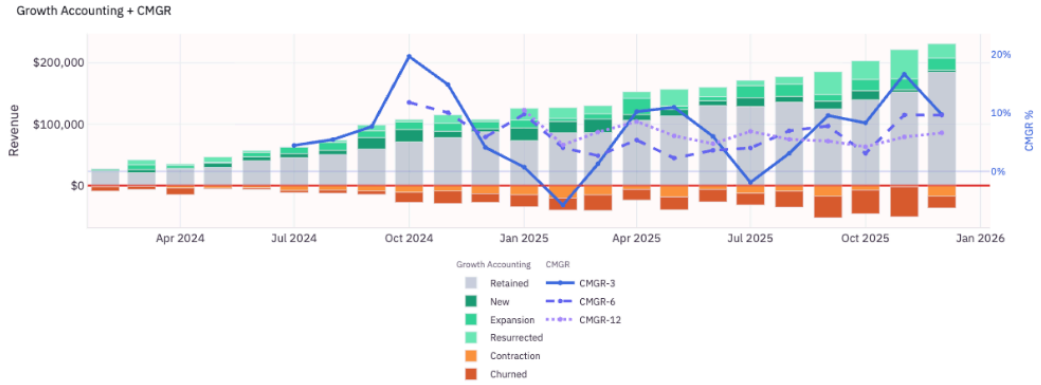
EXPANSION VS LOSSES

Gains: $46,092 · Losses: $36,409 · Coverage: **1.3x**

● 19 active ● 2 dormant ● 5 churned

GROWTH ACCOUNTING + CMGR

Revenue breakdown with compound monthly growth rate



CMGR3 (9.7%) leads CMGR12 (6.6%) — growth is **accelerating**

View monthly breakdown by partner →

Growth Accounting Approach

The growth accounting identity is not an exact model. It is seen more as an accounting framework as well as a broad analytical foundation to analyse startup success.

Every period, the active revenue base decomposes into mutually exclusive categories that must balance:

```
Revenue(t) = Retained + New + Expansion + Resurrected

Revenue(t-1) = Retained + Churned + Contraction
```

Quick Ratio

$$\frac{New + Resurrected + Expansion}{Churned + Contraction}$$

Mamoon Hamid of Kleiner Perkins measures growth efficiency. How many units gained for every unit lost.

>4x = very healthy, <1x = shrinking.

Gross Dollar Retention (GDR)

$$\frac{Retained\ Revenue}{Prior\ Period\ Revenue}$$

The floor how much revenue survives month-to-month without any new business.

Caps at 100%. B2B SaaS median: ~90%.

Net Dollar Retention (NDR)

$$\frac{Retained + Expansion + Resurrected}{Prior\ Period\ Revenue}$$

Whether the existing base is growing or shrinking.

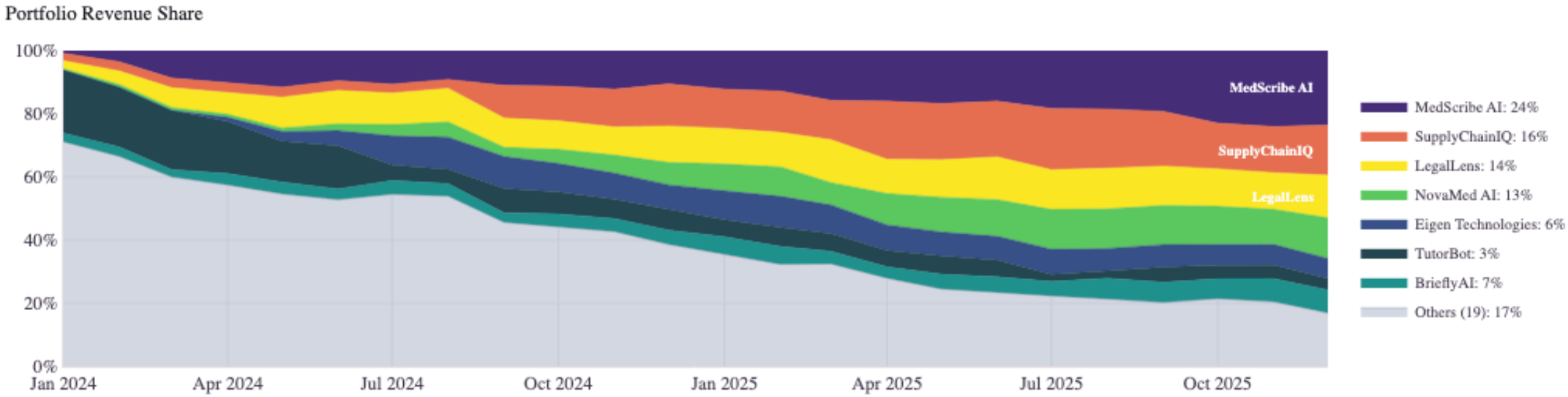
>100% = expansion exceeds losses (the goal). Enterprise B2B SaaS median: 110–118%.

Critically, the same Quick Ratio can mean very different things depending on the partner's use case. A consumer product with QR 2.0x (high churn offset by high new) is healthy. A B2B enterprise product with QR 2.0x (moderate churn, moderate new) may be concerning.

In the next section, we cover how we would go about interpreting data from two different businesses with distinct use cases.

Portfolio Revenue Share & Power Law Identification

In any startup portfolio, returns follow a power law. Similar to the Pareto Principle, a small number of partners generate the majority of revenue. In our portfolio, four partners account for 67% of total revenue. The remaining 22 collectively contribute 33%. This is expected and shown below.



The aim here is to identify these power law returners early, ideally while they are still in the "Others" band, growing their share before they break out. Essentially, to find the next set of winners of the portfolio such as MedScribe before they show T2D2 (Triple, Triple, Double, Double) growth trajectories.

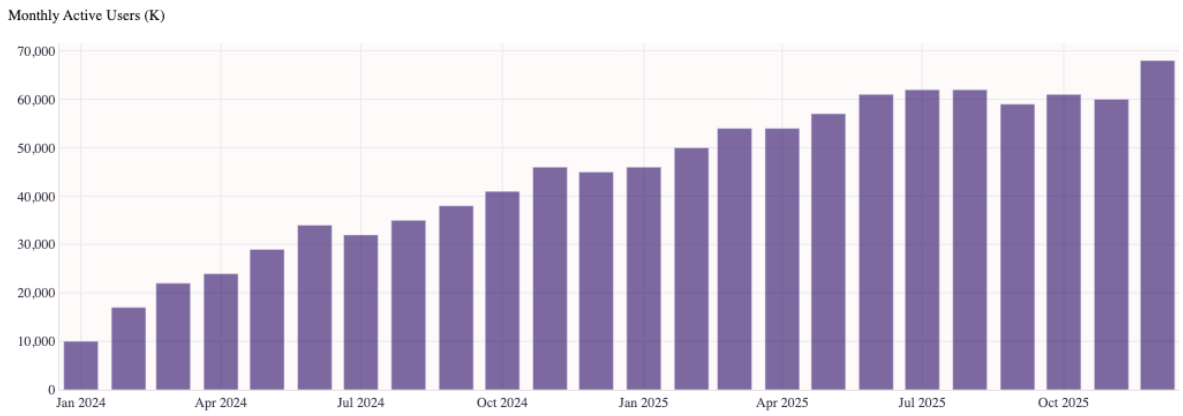
Partners demonstrating sustained share growth are candidates for increased resource allocation and earlier handoff to the internal account management team, ensuring the partnerships programme captures the full value of its best bets.

Case Studies

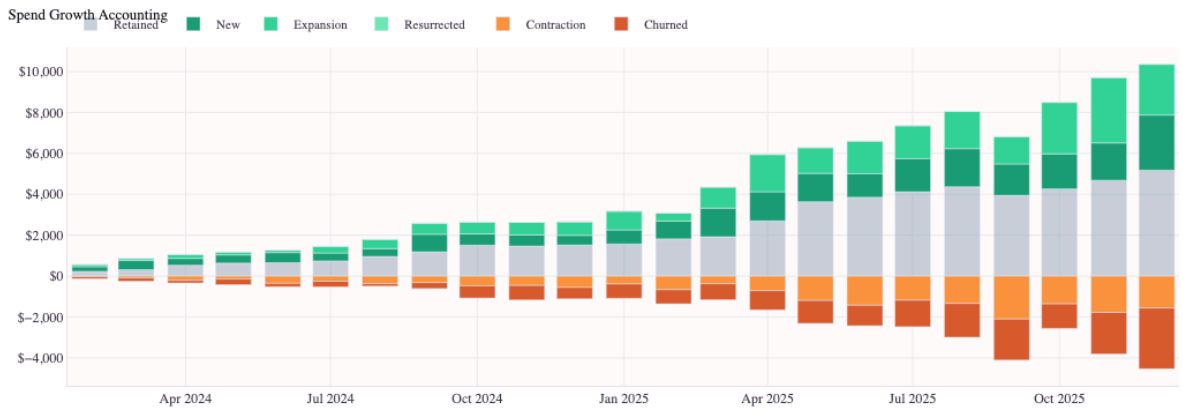
Company 1: WriteFlow

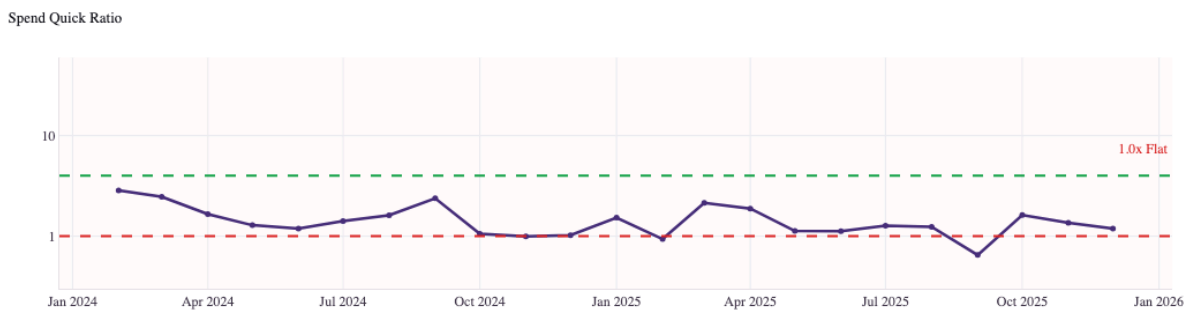
WriteFlow is a browser-based writing assistant where end-users interact directly with Claude. Every time a user clicks "Generate" or "Rewrite," that's an API call.

This is a consumer business, which means the growth accounting profile looks fundamentally different from B2B or a dev tool. In these B2C cases, relatively higher churn is expected and is often made up by growth. Typical MAU analyses do not take this into account, and where a growth accounting model becomes useful. Consider this. WriteFlow seems to be growing in MAU, as shown in the chart below. The differentiator here is the amounts, which we will analyse next.

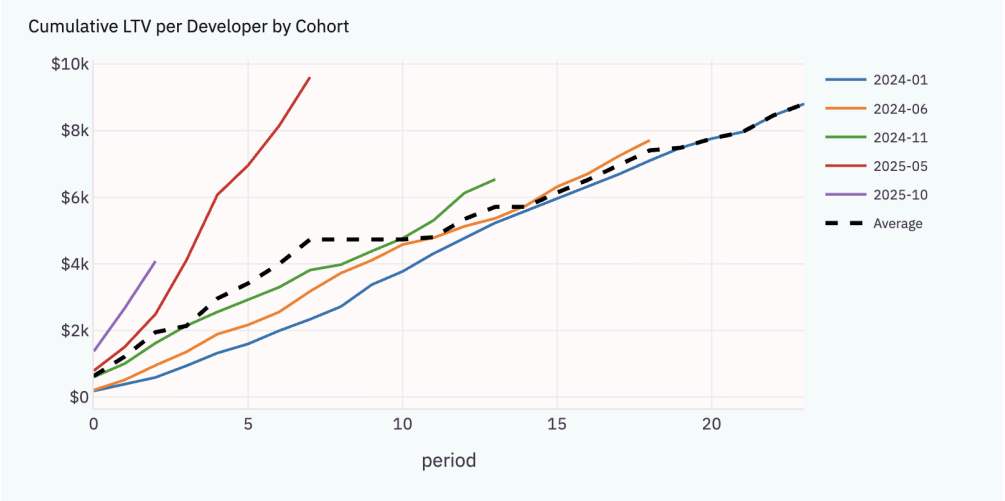


When we use our **growth accounting framework**, we can see diminishing returns with a Quick Ratio of 1.2x. WriteFlow sits below the 1.5x threshold that most VCs, consider the minimum for a healthy consumer product. Essentially, for every dollar of new revenue acquired, the company is losing roughly $0.83 to churn and contraction, a ratio that, if sustained, leads to revenue stagnation regardless of top-line growth.





However, when we go a layer deeper, the cohort LTV data introduces nuance. While headline churn is high, the retention curve shows stabilisation after month 2 — consistent with A16Z's framework for evaluating AI product retention, which benchmarks AI market benchmark rebasing from Month 3 to filter out "AI tourists" who were never genuine users.



The surviving cohorts show increasing spend over time, suggesting that new users who find value in the product deepen their usage, indicating recent developments within the product and pricing stickiness.

We also note that Gross Dollar Retention sits at approximately 55%, and Net Dollar Retention at 78%. In isolation, these numbers are concerning. They are well below the 90% GDR and 110%+ NDR benchmarks for B2B SaaS. But, again, looking at the nuance; WriteFlow is not B2B SaaS. Against consumer AI benchmarks, where ChartMogul reports a median NDR of 48% for AI-native products under $50/month, WriteFlow's 78% places it in the upper quartile of its peer set. y.

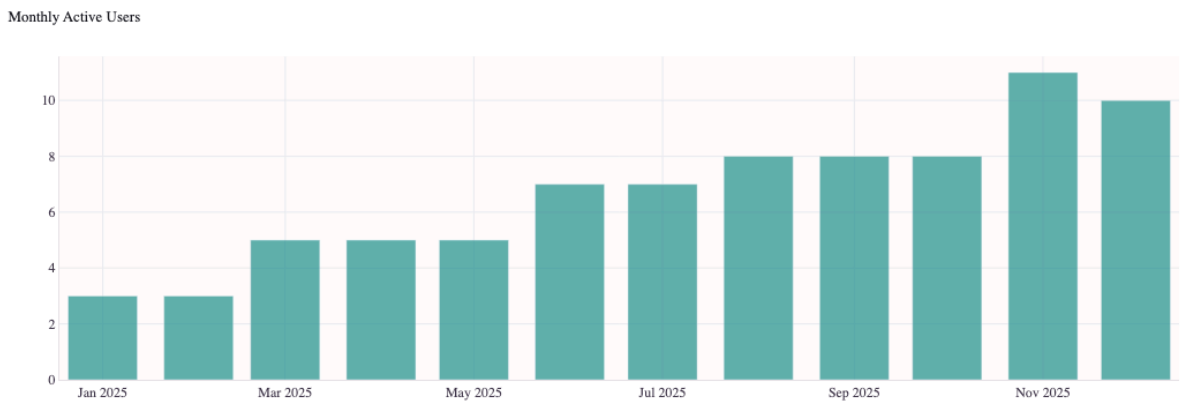
Reccomendation

The recommendation is to deprioritise and monitor with a specific lens: track Q3 and Q4 cohort retention as the leading indicators. If retention holds above 40% and conversion trends upward, the current acquisition-heavy model may be sustainable. If both are flat or declining, the leaky bucket will eventually overwhelm acquisitions, at which point resource allocation should shift to partners with stronger unit economics.

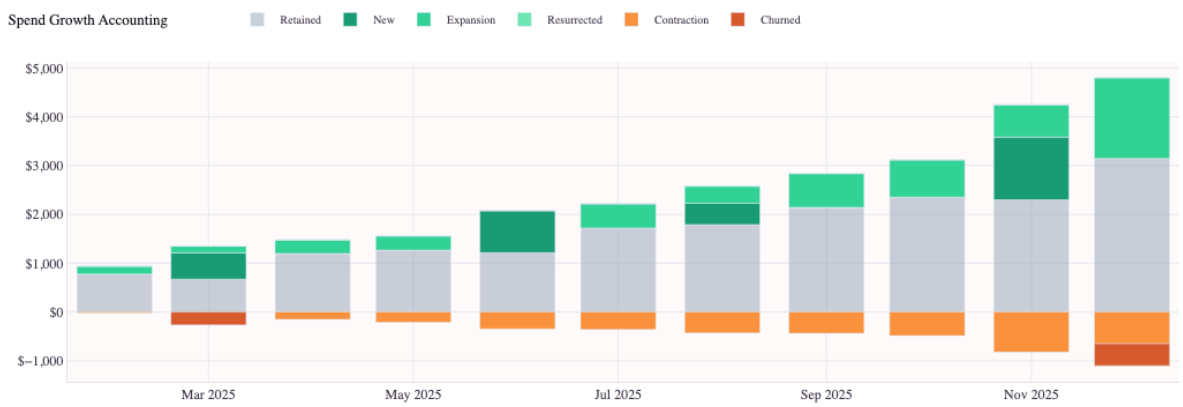
Company 2: BrieflyAI

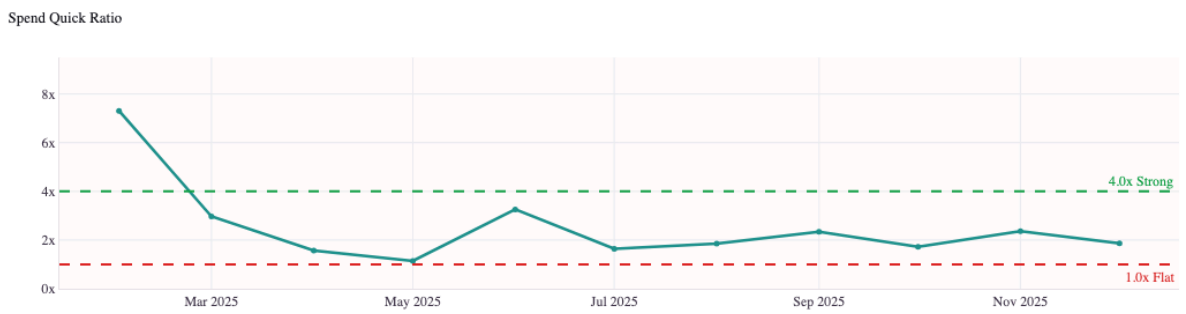
BrieflyAI records and transcribes business meetings using a compliant opt-in infrastructure. Claude generates structured summaries with action items and decisions and updates a company wide project, progress and task tracker. Sold per-seat to both individual users and mid-market firms, each enterprise client win is a discrete step-function in API usage.

This is both a B2C and B2B product, which means the growth accounting profile looks fundamentally different from WriteFlow. Revenue growth depends on which market gains traction first. B2B wins show up as step-functions, discrete jumps as new clients onboard, with flat or modestly expanding revenue between wins as existing clients add seats. B2C growth, if present, would appear as smoother, more gradual increases. In either case, churn should be low: once meeting summaries are embedded in a team's workflow.



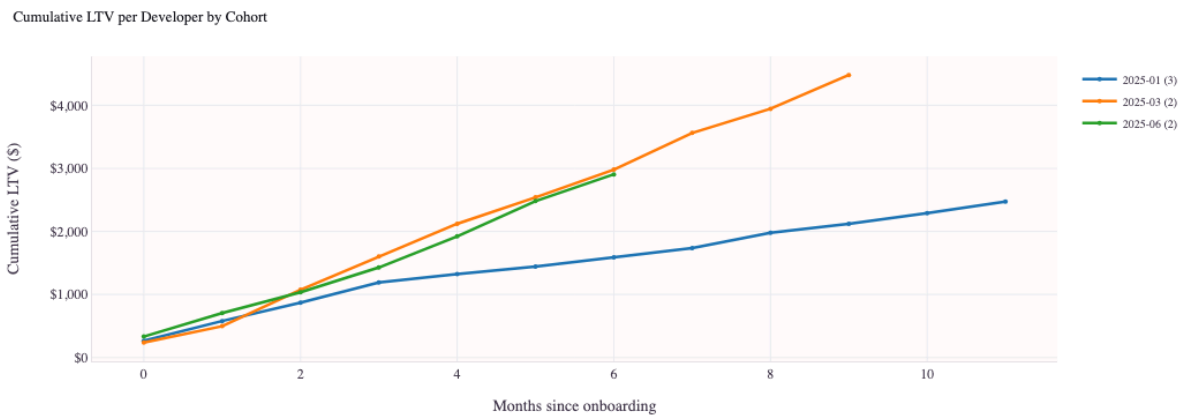
MAU here is not nearly as impressive as the previous company, nor is it showing growth. The growth accounting chart tells a different story from the headline numbers. We can quickly see this from the 2.4x Quick Ratio. While BrieflyAI's active developer count is modest at 11, the revenue profile underneath is striking. Revenue climbs in visible steps, each jump corresponding to a new enterprise client win, with retained revenue forming a stable, growing base between wins. There is minimal contraction and almost no churn.





At headline level, BrieflyAI's MRR of $4,800 is less than half of WriteFlow's $10,361. Its active developer count is fraction of WriteFlow's. While a surface level reading would deprioritise BrieflyAI for the higher current surface level metrics of Company 1 this second level analysis indicates that BrieflyAI is a much better allocation of internal resources in the long term, showing much stronger signals of long term PMF.

When we look at the 3 month trailing CMGR, a backward looking signal, we see a difference of over 15%, a 10x growth rate gap in medium to long term. The LTV map below confirms this, showing increased usage across lifetime with a meaningful jump from Cohort 1 to 2 &3.



Recommendation

BrieflyAI is the power law candidate. At its current CMGR, BrieflyAI's MRR overtakes WriteFlow's within <12 months. The metrics that matter NDR, GDR, Quick Ratio, cohort expansion all point in the same direction for Briefly. Continued CMGR which shows no signs of slowing down, would put this new startup in the 'one to watch' category.

The recommendation is to increase resource allocation now: prioritise technical support, explore co-marketing opportunities, and consider earlier handoff to the account management team. The window to deepen this partnership is while BrieflyAI is still small enough to value the attention when compared with WriteFlow.